SUNDAY 25 OCTOBER 2026
Thirtieth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:
Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 26 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm
Tuesday 27 Oct	Mass, 10.00am	Rosary, Castlederg: 2.00pm	Rosary, 10.00am
Wednesday 28 Oct	Liturgy of Word with Holy Communion: 10.00am	Castlederg: Liturgy of the Word, with Holy Communion: 10.00am Dregish: Rosary, 11.00am	Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 29 Oct	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 30 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	Mass, 7.30pm
Saturday 31 Oct	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm: Induction Mass of Fr Chris McDermott
Sunday 1 Nov: All Saints Day	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am: *Additional Mass for All Saints Day* Drumnabey,12.30pm	Mass, 11.00am: *Month's Mind, Brendan Cassidy*

ST PATRICK'S, DRUMQUIN – Fr Chris McDermott will be formally inducted as Parish Priest of Langfield (Drumquin) next Saturday evening, 31 October, by Bishop Michael Router, at an Installation Ceremony at the 5.00pm Vigil Mass in St Patrick's Church.
In looking forward to welcoming Fr Chris to Drumquin, we also welcome Bishop Router to the parish for the first time. There will be tea in the hall for everyone afterwards and a chance to meet the new Parish Priest and the new Bishop!

Fr Chris' induction as Parish Priest of Aghyaran is scheduled to take place at the 7.30pm Vigil Mass on Saturday 7 November and then in Ardstraw West & Castlederg at the 11.00am Mass in Castlederg on Sunday 22 November. Further details next week.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:
AGHYARAN: £1,262 & €11.
ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £1,756 & €74, made up of:
Castlederg £938 & €59, **Drumnabey** £557 & €15, **Dregish** £261. **DRUMQUIN:** £1,078.
Thank you, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order. In September these amounted to:
Aghyaran: £881 & €20 CRF £692; **Ardstraw West Castlederg:** £2,394; **Drumquin:** £2,245.

ARDSTRAW WEST AND CASTLEDERG Parish Draw: The October draw will take place after Mass in Dregish today.

SVP Meeting takes place this Wednesday, 28 October, in the Parochial House, Drumquin, at 7.30pm.

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We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Rosemary Donnell, late of 10 Mount Bernard Rise, Castlederg, whose Funeral Mass took place in Strabane on Wednesday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to Rosemary's family and to all who mourn her death. May she rest in peace.

PLEASE NOTE the following dates for November Masses remembering those who have died in the past year.
A candle in remembrance of each of those who have died will be lit:

CASTLEDERG: Monday 2 November, 7.30pm, remembering: Joe Gallagher, Pat Carolan, James Murray, Delma MvGlynn, Ellen Sweeney, Tom McHugh, Derek Duggan, Pat Keenan, Marrie McMenamin, Ann T. Doherty, Angela Laird, Doris Gallagher, Colleen Vukusic (nee Masterson), Brendan Douglas, Charlie Logue, Christine Clarke, Michael Harper, Evelyn Baxter, Molly Carlin.

AGHYARAN: Friday 6 November, 7.30pm, remembering: Noel Doherty, Ellen Lynch, Peter Moss, Madge McNamee, Danny Gallen, Danny O'Donnell, Don Browne.

DRUMQUIN: Saturday 7 November, 5.00pm, remembering: Mickey McLaughlin, Margaret McLaughlin, Tommy Kearney, Margaret McLaughlin, Cameron Donnelly, Paddy Gallagher, Fiona Scott, Joe Campbell, Gerry O'Kane, Frankie Breen, Brendan Cassidy.

DREGISH: Sunday 8 November, 9.30am, remembering Kay Nugent.

DRUMNABEY: Sunday 8 November, 12.30pm, remembering: Hannah Devine, Terry Logue, Brendan (Bo) Lennon.

Families who have been bereaved in the past year are asked to check that the name of their loved one has been included above. If you have any query, please contact the Parish Office.

IVY'S DANCE – CASTLEDERG COMMITTEE OF CANCER RESEARCH UK: Sat 31 October, Scraghey Community Centre. Dancing from 9.30pm. Music by Charlie and Claire. Adm £8. Raffle on the night. Light refreshments served.

BEGINNERS' UPHOLSTERY CLASS in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, Thursday 5 November, 6.30pm to 9.00pm. Cost £10 and booking is essential. All materials supplied. For information or to book, contact Claire on 07818091136.

BOOK LAUNCH: Dregish History Group invite you to a Book Launch in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, on Fri 13 Nov, at 7.30pm; refreshments will be served. The Group has produced two books, available at the event for purchase. One contains a selection of interesting local history articles by members of the Dregish History Group called ***'Gathering Hidden Gems on the History of Dregish and the People Together'.*** The second is a history of the ***Clergy of Adrstraw West*** by Brian Devenney, edited by Fr McCawille. Thank you to NLH Fund and Rapid for their support.

THANK YOU: Deborah Lowry offers her thanks to all who supported in any way the ***Team Hope Garden Tea Party*** at her home in September. She is most appreciative of the generosity shown by the entire community and is delighted to share that the event raised almost £5,000. The funds raised will support Team Hope's longer-term development work, helping vulnerable families and communities overseas to build more secure and hopeful futures.

TEAM HOPE CHRISTMAS SHOE-BOX APPEAL for children in Africa and Eastern Europe: You are invited to fill a wrapped shoebox with gifts using the 4Ws - something to Write, Wash, Wear and Wow, and include a €6 contribution towards transport and delivery. Shoeboxes can be dropped off between 1 and 10 Nov at Castle Coffee, or Urban Barn/Pet Store, both in Castlederg. For further details, labels and guidance, visit www.teamhope.ie. Thank you, from Deborah Lowry and all at Team Hope!

As our parishes prepare to welcome Fr Chris next weekend, Fr Thomas and I take this opportunity to wish him every blessing in his ministry in Aghyaran, Ardstraw West & Castlederg and Drumquin.

Born in 1986, Fr Chris is a native of Leckpatrick Parish. His parents, Rosemary and Sean, live in Strabane. Fr Chris tells us that his three brothers, two nieces and a nephew form his closest family. Following school, Chris was employed for several years in an administrative role at the Oncology Department of Altnagelvin Hospital. He subsequently pursued seminary studies at St Malachy's College, Belfast, and St Patrick's College, Maynooth. Since ordination in June 2016, Fr Chris has ministered among the faith communities of St Eugene's Cathedral in Derry, Drumragh (Omagh), Limavady, Kilrea & Desertoghill, Errigal (Garvagh) and Granaghan (Swatragh).

Fr Chris says that, after spending the last five years 'on the missions' in Co Derry, he now looks forward to serving the people of the West Tyrone Pastoral Area. He and Kobe (the pet dog) will take up residence in Castlederg Parochial House at the end of the month.

Fr Chris brings many gifts to his ministry and, in giving generously of himself to serving the people entrusted to his care, I know that he will enjoy the support and encouragement of you all. I pray God's blessing on all that you will share and accomplish together.

Please keep Fr Chris in your prayers as he prepares to move to Castlederg and begin the next chapter of his priestly ministry in the West Tyrone Pastoral Area.

May God bless you all,

Fr Paul.